

The NFL Innovation Challenge, Redesigned

From a High-Cost Experiential Program to a High-Impact Insight Engine

We have transformed the NFL Innovation Challenge into a **lean, virtual-first model** that delivers our core strategic goals for **under \$100K, powered by a repeatable, tech-enabled framework.**

VIRTUAL-FIRST
MODEL

REPEATABLE
FRAMEWORK

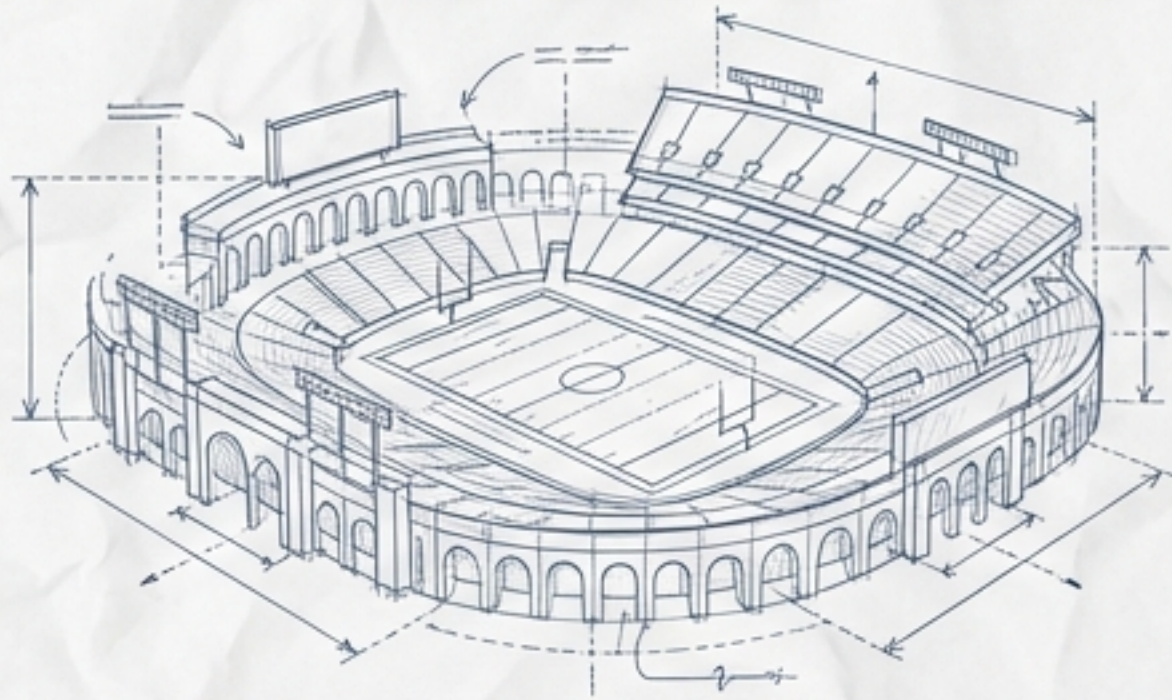
TECH-ENABLED
ENGINE

COST EFFICIENCY
(<\$100K)

Program Design by **NOVATE** | Technical Orchestration by **Sentra**

A Strategic Pivot to a Smarter, More Agile Model

THE ORIGINAL BLUEPRINT



Model: Multi-phase, experiential program with significant on-site activations (Atlanta Qualifier, Super Bowl Reveal).



Focus: Broad outreach, high-cost activations, and event-driven storytelling.



Budget: \$750K - \$1.2M



Complexity: Multiple large-scale event production workstreams, extensive logistics.

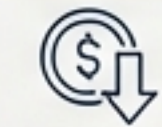
THE NEW DIGITAL SCHEMATIC



Model: Lean, virtual-first submission and review, culminating in a single in-person showcase at the NFL Draft.



Focus: Sourcing **real*, adaptable solutions with high relevance to the OnePass ecosystem.



Budget: <\$100K



Efficiency: Tech-enabled orchestration, automated scoring, repeatable framework.

Preserving the Mission While Optimizing the Method

Original Intent:

Create an innovation pipeline.

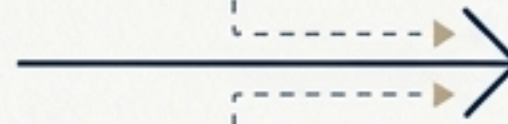


Updated Design:

Achieved via a virtual-first challenge with MVP validation and targeted cross-industry scouting.

Original Intent:

Show League commitment to innovation.



Updated Design:

Achieved through centralized NFL announcements and a strategic marketing narrative developed by NOVATE.

Original Intent:

Source viable MVPs for OnePass.

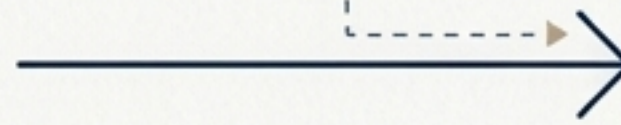


Updated Design:

Achieved with intake criteria structured around technical feasibility, business readiness, and direct relevance to the OnePass ecosystem.

Original Intent:

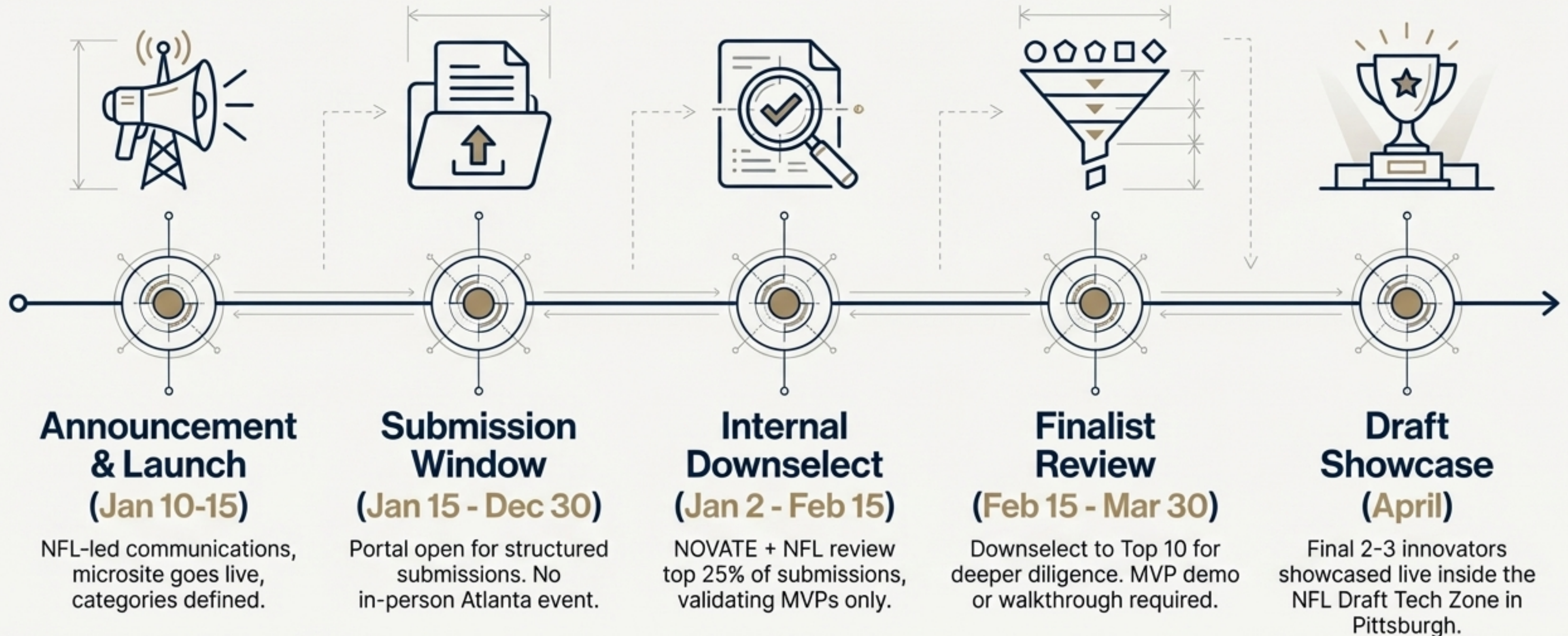
Use the Draft for innovation visibility.



Updated Design:

Preserved with the Finalist Demo Zone and winner announcement positioned at the Draft.

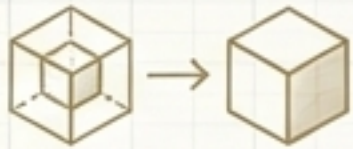
The New Challenge Blueprint: A 5-Gate Journey to the Draft



Sourcing Applied Innovation, Not Just Ideas

Primary Target Audience

Venture-backed startups and emerging tech companies (Pre-Seed to Series B)



- Must have a working MVP or live product (no slideware)



- Ideally deployed in adjacent verticals (travel, fintech, retail media, civic tech)



- Seeking a marquee pilot to break into the sports & entertainment industry

Who It's NOT For



- Idea-stage founders with no prototype



- General student teams or hobbyist hackers



- Consultants or agencies posing as product teams

The Challenge: Enhance the NFL OnePass Ecosystem

The NFL is seeking real-world solutions that can enhance, extend, or integrate with the OnePass ecosystem to elevate fan experience, operational insight, and global event intelligence.



1. Fan Journey & Personalization

How technology can help fans feel seen, valued, and engaged.

(Examples: AI itinerary builders, interoperable wallets, AR pre-event content)



2. Local Monetization & Commerce

How to deepen connections with local economies.

(Examples: Hyper-local commerce layers, context-aware sponsorship tools)



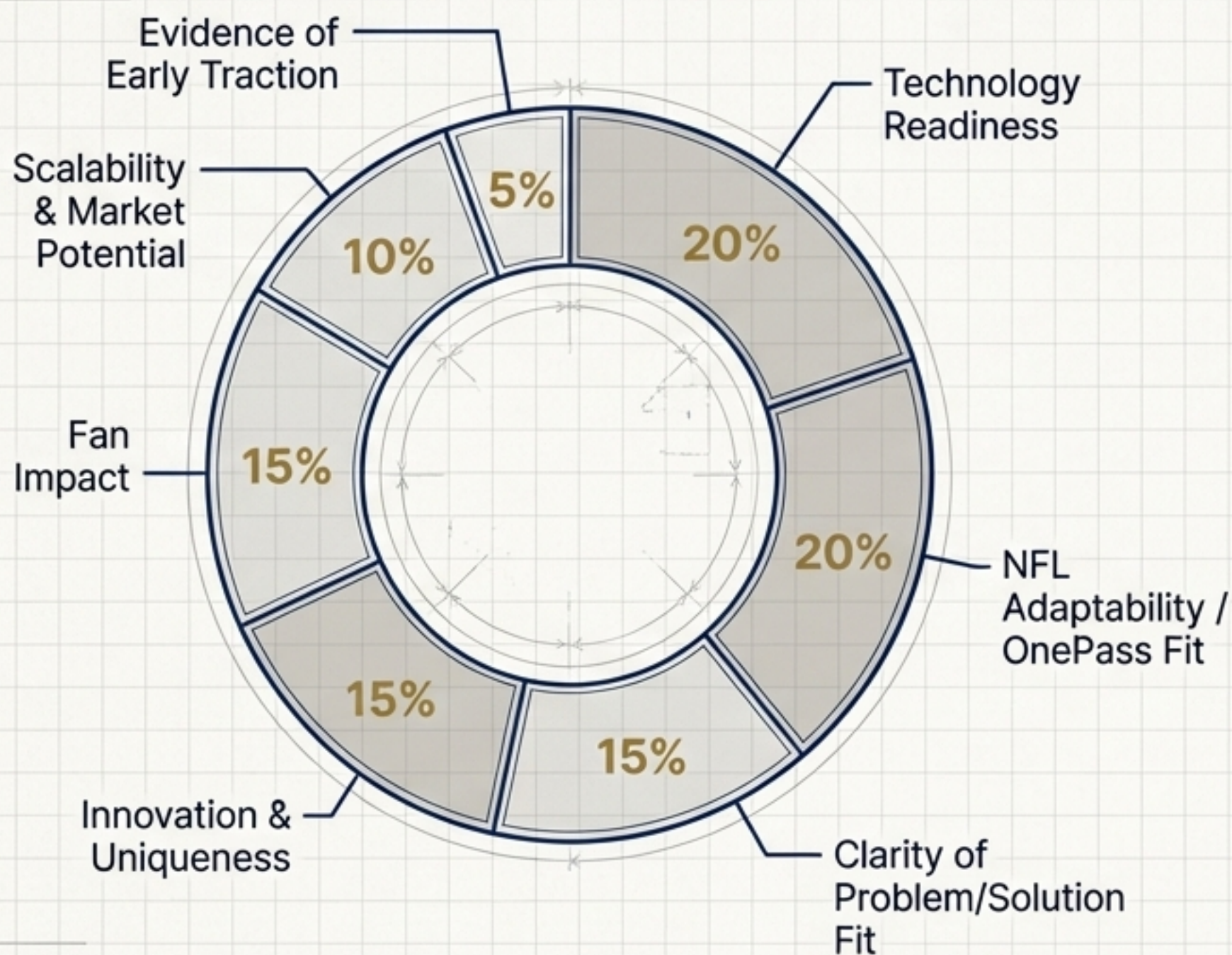
3. Event Discovery & Global Engagement

How global fans can discover and engage with events remotely.

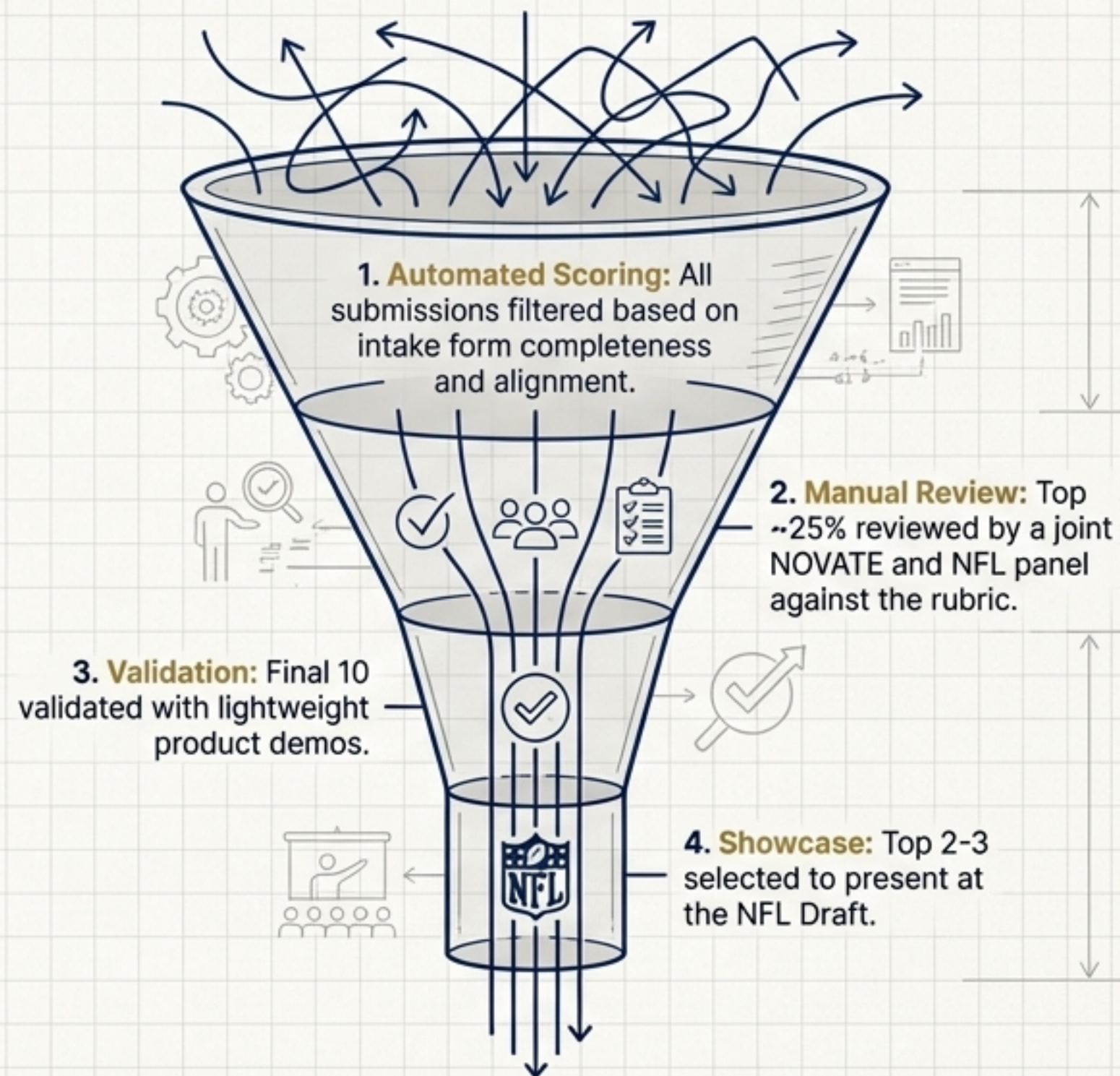
(Examples: Global event mapping, localized interfaces, integrated travel features)

A Standardized Rubric to Separate Signal from Noise

Evaluation Criteria



The Scoring Pipeline



The Operating Model: A Partnership Built on Clear Roles



NFL

- **Ownership:** Announcements, media outreach, sponsor engagement.
- **Decision-Making:** Defines evaluation criteria and makes ultimate selections.
- **Assets:** Owns final approvals and all public-facing assets.



NOVATE Solutions

- **Ownership:** Portal and submission operations, review facilitation, program integrity.
- **Decision-Making:** Designs the intake, scoring architecture, and evaluation methodology.
- **Assets:** Controls all creative assets and storytelling deliverables; retains IP over the challenge framework.

The Engine Room: Powered by the Sentrais Platform

The new model is enabled by Sentrais, the intelligent backend engine for challenge submission, scoring, and analytics.



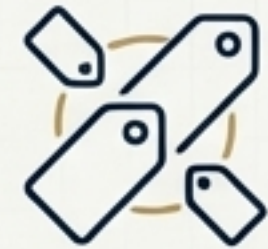
Automated Intake & Scoring

Uses NLP to extract tags from submissions and applies a pre-trained rubric for an initial score, filtering the top 40% for manual review.



End-to-End Tracking

All program gates are tracked in Sentrais with API callouts for key dates, content artifacts, and scoring thresholds.



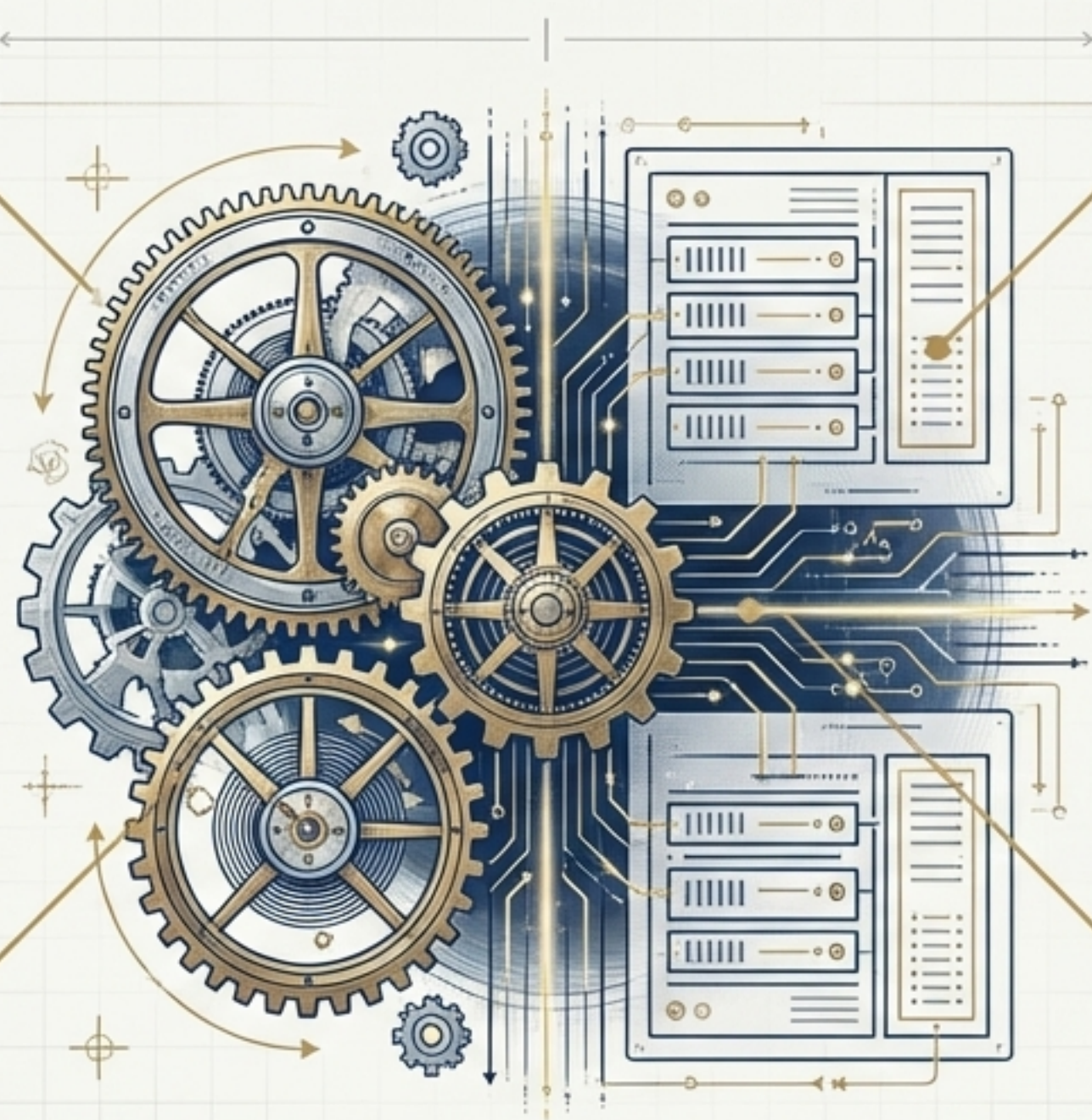
Intelligent Tagging

Flags submissions by category, risk level, MVP status, and "retrofit potential."



Stakeholder Management

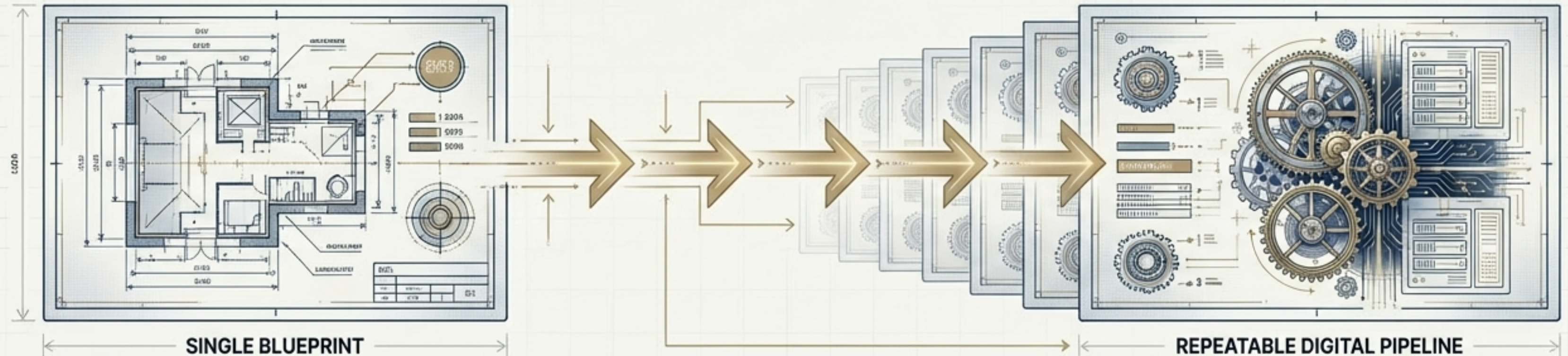
Captures and organizes all stakeholders (judges, mentors, etc.) by role, availability, and permissions.



From a One-Off Event to a Repeatable Innovation Pipeline

This challenge is the first implementation of NOVATE's
Innovation Orchestration Framework.

A discipline that transforms innovation from a collection of independent pilots into a unified system for discovery, validation, and learning. It moves beyond "innovation theater" to build systematic, ecosystem-wide capability.



**Challenge
Blueprint Object**

This isn't just a hackathon. It's the creation of a reusable '**Challenge Blueprint Object**' in Sentrais, establishing a branded platform for all future NFL fan-centric innovation sourcing. It positions Sentrais as an "Innovation-as-a-Service" platform for the League.

High-Impact Innovation on a Lean, Focused Budget



Protecting the Architecture and Ensuring Future Value

NOVATE IP

IP OWNERSHIP

NOVATE Retains All IP Rights To:

- The challenge methodology and evaluation rubric.
- The Innovation Orchestration Framework and its workflows.
- The blueprint model for future replication.

IP OWNERSHIP

FRAMEWORK SECURITY

Sentra's Value Capture:

- Serves as the exclusive backend engine for submission, scoring, and analytics.
- Enables scalable reuse of the challenge architecture.
- Technical partner callout embedded in all internal program reports.

BACKEND ENGINE

SCALABILITY CAPABILITY

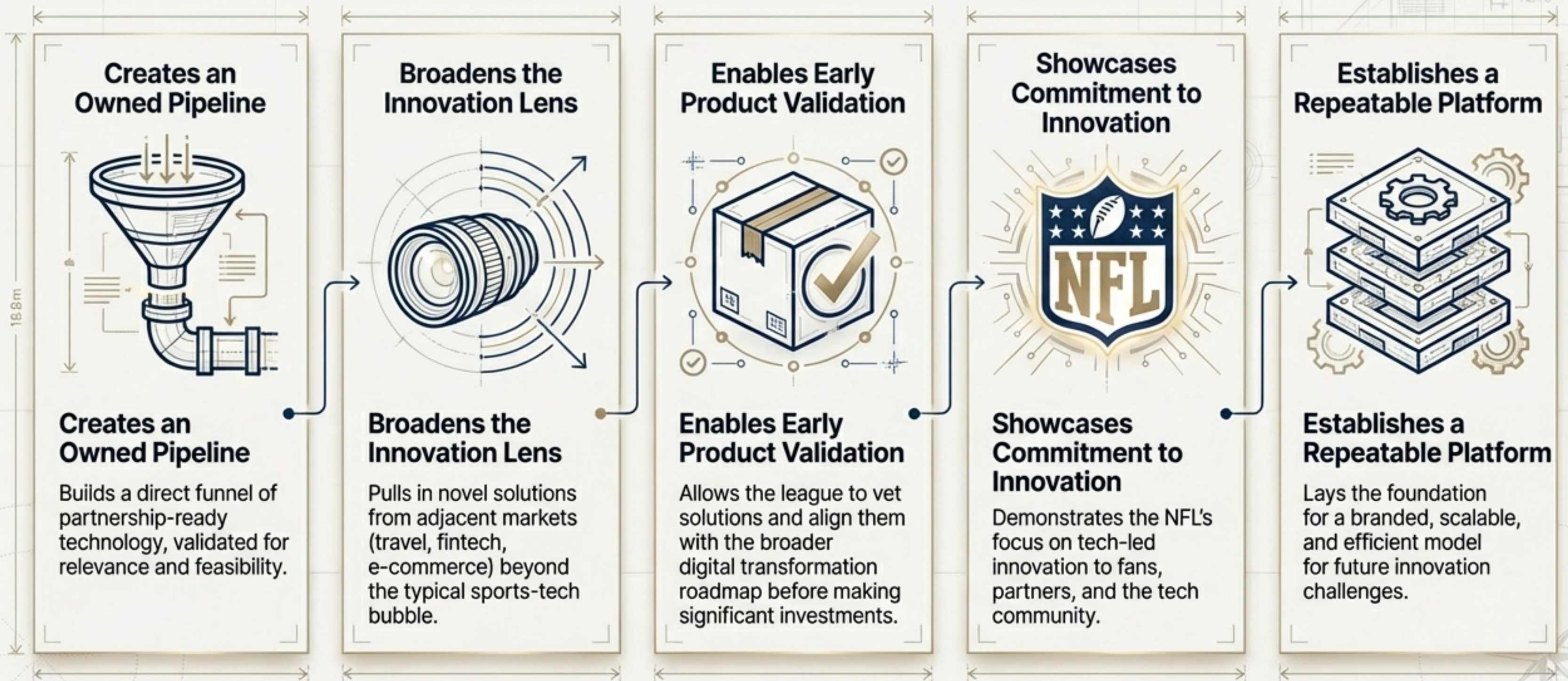
LICENSE DURATION

Terms of Engagement:

- The NFL has license to use this implementation for this challenge cycle only.
- All extensions, adaptations, or replications require NOVATE participation or license.
- NOVATE reserves the right to publish case studies and co-branded outcomes post-Draft.

FUTURE USE

Delivering a Strategic Pipeline of Partnership-Ready Tech





Activating the Playbook: Immediate Next Steps

Phase 1: Finalize & Approve (Target: Jan 3)

-  Finalize updated copy and revised categories for the microsite.
-  Approve the final submission intake structure and scoring guardrails.
-  Confirm the final Draft showcase format and NFL ownership of comms.

Phase 2: Build & Launch (Target: Jan 10)

-  Coordinate creative and digital QA with NFL Digital for launch.
-  Initiate standup of the Sentrais Challenge Engine (Intake → Review → Dashboard).
-  Build NOVATE's internal documentation to serve as the reusable template.

The New Foundation: Building the NFL's Innovation Capability

The redesigned NFL Innovation Challenge has successfully pivoted from a costly one-time event into a strategic asset. By leveraging the Innovation Orchestration Framework and the Sentrais engine, we have built more than a competition; we have established a lean, intelligent, and repeatable capability for sourcing and validating the future of the fan experience.

